Edward Puentes - Teardown #1

Interview context

After interviewing one gym-goer, X, I chose Hevy for a hands-on teardown. X used its free plans and videos but could not correct a Romanian deadlift after watching the clip three times; recording himself in the gym felt inconvenient.

My Hevy teardown

Starting an exercise

Hevy offers a free exercise library. From the main page, I could select an exercise and start it. I could watch a video when I wanted a demonstration. The path to active guidance was harder to understand: I did not find a clear "guide me" action from the main page. The UI looked polished, but the navigation was not always intuitive for someone seeking form help.

Logging and free use

Workout logging worked well. The app made it easy to record the workout and return to the routine, and the videos were useful when I was confused about a movement. The free version did not load me with ads. These are real strengths; Formly should complement them rather than assume users need a new workout log.

Pricing and Pro features

The listed Hevy Pro price was $2.99 per month or $23.99 per year in USD. Personalized programs and Trainer guidance are Pro features. Pro also offers more extensive progress reporting, while the free version still supports core logging and some progress viewing. Hevy's pricing comparison lists the same prices, and its Pro feature table describes the feature limits.

Points of hesitation

- **Personalized sets:** I could log sets in the free version, but it did not suggest sets, weights, or reps tailored to me. Those recommendations are part of Hevy Trainer in Pro.
- **Feedback:** The personalized training feedback I found was reserved for Pro. I did not find live correction of my exercise form.
- **Video variety:** The free exercise library showed one demonstration video per exercise, with no second view to try when a clip was unclear.

Strengths, gaps, and Formly implication

Strengths: Hevy has a useful free exercise library, good workout logging, helpful demonstration clips, an attractive interface, and an ad-free free experience.

Gaps: The path to form guidance is not obvious from the main page, and a demonstration does not assess the user's own movement in real time. X's interview shows the practical consequence: repeated viewing did not tell him what to change.

Formly implication: Test whether timely feedback about the user's own form resolves that gap without adding the phone setup burden X described. Audio or haptic cues are possibilities to test, not findings from this teardown.